Sampath Phani Sai Mallik Kakarla

Urban Planning & GIS Specialist | Operations & Technical Development Lead

Vijayawada, Andhra Pradesh, India (Open to Relocation)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- *4 years of progressive, senior-level experience as the **sole on-ground lead of a geospatial consultancy**; running day-to-day delivery, team operations, and client interactions from the office in India while the founding partner worked part-time, fully remotely from the Netherlands during her master's.*
- *Designed a 10-stage GIS delivery framework, built all operational systems from scratch, and engineered automations that reduced workflow processing time by over 80%, while hiring and managing a team of up to 10.*
- *Delivered city-scale geospatial mapping **across 35–40 cities on 5 continents (estimated 1.5M+ individually attributed parcels)**, and led **outreach** to Dutch municipalities, Indian government tenders, and freelance platforms, including prospective **research and stakeholder interviews** to shape expansion strategy, with deep capability in GIS, spatial Python, and API systems, built on a B.Plan from SPA Vijayawada and prior work with WRI India and AMRUT/Visakhapatnam master plans.*

EXPERIENCE

❖ Planning Saga (VBJ Consultancy Pvt. Ltd.) — *Jun 2022 – Jun 2026*

India

Operations & Development Lead (Sep 2024–Jun 2026) · Senior Associate & Technical Lead (Mar 2023–Aug 2024) · GIS Associate (Jun 2022–Mar 2023)

- Operated as the **sole on-ground lead** for a GIS consultancy across 4 years — building and owning all operations, workflows, systems, and client interactions from the ground up, with the founding partner working part-time remotely.
- Led delivery of city-scale geospatial mapping across **35–40 cities on 5 continents** (Europe, Americas, Australia, Middle East, East Asia) — delivering an estimated **1.5M+ individually attributed plot-level land parcels** as GeoJSON vector layers for a global metaverse real-estate platform.
- Architected and continuously refined a **10-stage GIS delivery framework** (Mapping → Mapping Review → Geometric Cleaning → Address Extraction → Address Cleaning → Address Merge → Spatial Cleaning → Sampling → Final Clean → Final Review), with QA checkpoints at neighbourhood and city levels; developed **Workflow Procedures** — step-by-step process guides per workflow stage — alongside city preparation protocols and post-delivery retrospectives.
- Managed and partially developed a **ClickUp-based operational infrastructure** from scratch — city-as-project structure, stage-specific task checklists, team dashboards with time tracking — enabling consistent parallel delivery across multiple cities simultaneously.
- Engineered **automations** for batch parcel address extraction — parsing data responses, cleaning address components, and flagging errors requiring manual intervention — reducing processing time by **83%** (1.5 hrs → 0.25 hrs per 1,000 parcels), applied across **1M+ parcels** post-deployment.
- **Built and owned the complete end-to-end hiring process** — sourcing, technical screening, assignment-based evaluation, and final interviews; designed onboarding and training programmes; conducted performance reviews; led all strategic workload allocation and delivery planning for a consistent team of up to 10.
- Served as **primary client liaison** for ~3 years — weekly progress and strategy reporting; drafted the pre-final **Client-Consultant service agreement from scratch**.
- Led **business development outreach** to Dutch municipalities, Indian government tender opportunities, and freelance platforms; conducted prospective city-level research and stakeholder interviews to support project expansion strategy.

OTHER ROLES & INTERNSHIPS

❖ Guest Faculty — GIS & BIM — RVS College of Architecture, Chennai — *Aug – Oct 2022*

Virtual | Part-time role

- Delivered weekly virtual lectures for M.Arch students covering GIS fundamentals — data types, spatial analysis, GIS workflows, and thematic map creation — through to introductory BIM concepts.
- Managed the course structure planning and session delivery independently.

❖ GIS & Data Visualisation Intern — World Resources Institute (WRI) India — under WIPRO India — *Apr – May 2021*

Mumbai (Remote)

- Part of WIPRO Earthian's Sustainability – Continuous Engagement Programme; shortlisted to join WRI India from SPA Vijayawada.
- Maharashtra State Road Crash Data Visualisation & Analysis using GIS and MS Office tools; contributed to the published Mumbai City crash data report — **acknowledged by name** in the published document.
- Crash data analysis for different zones of Mumbai City and several districts of Maharashtra State.
- Published and acknowledged in Road Accidents in Maharashtra – 2020 by Accident Research Cell, Mumbai.

❖ GIS & Planning Intern — AMRUT Master Plan Scheme – Under SPA Vijayawada as Consultant — *Jan – Jun 2021*

Bhimavaram & SPA Vijayawada

- GIS-based Master Plan project for Bhimavaram — land-use mapping, spatial data attribution, and GIS analysis in support of the AMRUT planning framework.
- Progressively took co-ownership of the complete GIS dataset for the Bhimavaram Land-use Master Plan, independently managing it through to draft stage.

❖ Project Intern — Greater Visakhapatnam Regional Plan – Lea Associates South Asia — *Jun – Sep 2021*

Visakhapatnam

- Contributed to the Master Plan and Perspective Plan for the Visakhapatnam-Kakinada-Srikakulam Special Development Zone during the Draft Master Plan Public Consultation and Revision Phase.

EDUCATION

❖ **Bachelor of Planning (B.Plan)** ..... *2018 – 2022*

School of Planning and Architecture (SPA), Vijayawada GPA: 7.74 / 10

Dissertation: Assessment and Mitigation of Earthquake-Triggered Landslides in Urban Environments For Mizoram State — Mapped high-risk co-seismic landslide zones integrating seismic and geomorphic datasets (slope, lithology, land-use, drainage). Developed a Landslide Hazard Index (LHI) and Earthquake Hazard Index (EQI) using GIS-based multi-criteria analysis. Identified Tlangnuam tehsil as highest-risk zone; proposed community-based resilience strategies and policy-level land-use controls.

SELECTED ACADEMIC PROJECTS

❖ **Kasaragod Regional Plan**
Kasaragod District, 2021
Socio-economic development plan addressing backwardness, resource potential, and growth promotion.

❖ **Industrial Development Plan**
Visakhapatnam, 2020
Local area industrial re-development plan for a major automotive industrial core in Autonagar area, Visakhapatnam.

❖ **NMV Corridor Proposal**
Vijayawada, 2020
Studied travel behaviour and NMT infrastructure gaps across four wards of Vijayawada's institutional zone; proposed a segregated cycle track and pedestrian network with universal accessibility features, following IRC 2012, ITDP, and MoUD NMT guidelines.

❖ **Network Analysis for Suburbs**
Vijayawada, 2019
Shortest Route, Closest Facilities, Service Area Analysis, and Origin-Destination Matrix study using ArcGIS Network Analyst tools. (Personal interest project)

❖ **Slum Area Analysis**
Vijayawada, 2019
Settlement characteristics and livability assessment of Christhurajapuram Slum; presented at Local Dissemination Workshop by BINUCOM conducted at SPA Vijayawada.

❖ **Govt. Added Housing Study**
Vijayawada, 2019
JNNURM Housing Site Planning Scheme analysis; buffers, terrains, and infrastructure analysis for low-income housing typologies.

OTHER COURSES

❖ Spatial Data Science in Urban Planning (Open Course) ..... *TU Delft — Prof. Trivik Verma*

❖ Geo-Spatial Analysis in Urban Planning ..... *IIT Kharagpur on SWAYAM / NPTEL*

❖ Data Science: Linear Regression ..... *MIT*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

GIS & Spatial: QGIS, ArcGIS / ArcMap, MapBox, Surfer, Remote Sensing & Satellite Imagery Analysis

Programming: Python (pandas, geopandas, requests, xml.etree, matplotlib, scikit-learn), Google Apps Script, SQL

APIs & Data: Google API Integration & Management (Geocoding API, Places API, Maps Platform, Batch Processing), Cadastral data processing

Project Management: ClickUp (advanced — project boards, stage workflows, dashboards, documentation, time tracking), Google Workspace Admin

Design & CAD: AutoCAD, SketchUp, Adobe Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, Lightroom), MS Office

Analysis: Spatial Analysis, SPSS, Point Cloud / LiDAR basics, 3D data (cleaning & classification)

CERTIFICATIONS

❖ **Applied Remote Sensing Training Program — Satellite RS on Urban Heat Islands** ..... *NASA*

❖ **Code in Place — Python for Data, Graphics & Systems** ..... *Stanford University*

RECOGNITION & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **2nd Place** — NOSPLAN Convention '22: Design it Accessible hosted by NIUA — Universal Accessibility Design for Kochi Smart City
- Presented at National Workshop on *Main-streaming Disability Inclusion to Transform Urban Futures* hosted by National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA), held at Indian Habitat Centre, New Delhi.
- **1st Place** — NOSPLAN Convention '21: East Kollaka Wetlands and its Applicability in Pallikara Wetlands as part of Current Practices
- Publication/Acknowledged contributor: Maharashtra State Road Crash Data Report — WRI India (published)
- Presentation/Livability Assessment of Chinthuruppalam Slum — BINUCOM Local Dissemination Workshop, SPA Vijayawada
- **1st Place** — Speech Competition on Water Conservation: Swacch Pakhwada Programme, SPA Vijayawada